Visitor Identification: How It Works

Recycle Technologies website · prepared by Marketing · 29 October 2026

In one sentence

When someone visits our website from a **company, school, government or bank network**, the website works out which organisation that network belongs to, records which pages they read and how they found us, and shows it to the team as a **Visitor lead**, so sales can follow up with companies that never filled in a form.

How we get the IP address

Every device on the internet has an **IP address**, like a return address on an envelope. Whenever any browser opens any website, the connection has to carry that address, otherwise the website could not send the page back. So our server **already receives it automatically** with every page request, the same way every website and web server does.

- We do **not** ask the visitor for anything, and there is **no outside tracking script** on our pages.
- Our server sits behind a proxy; the proxy passes the visitor's address to the website in a standard header (X-Forwarded-For).
- When someone is at work, that address belongs to their **employer's office network**, and that is what tells us the company.

How the IP becomes a company name

The website sends the IP address to **ipapi.is**, a lookup service that keeps the public registry of who owns each block of internet addresses. It answers with the network owner: name, website domain, type (business, school, government, bank, internet provider, hosting), city and state, and whether it is a VPN or proxy.

The lookup says	What we do
Business, school, government or bank	**Keep it.** Create the company and mark the Visitor lead **Business IP**.
Home or mobile internet provider (Comcast, Verizon…)	Stay anonymous. We cannot know who the person is.
VPN, proxy, cloud or data centre, Apple or Google relays	Ignore it. Not a real company visit.
Our own offices and team VPNs	Never looked up.

Step by step

1. A visitor opens the site. The cookie banner asks for consent. **Nothing is collected until they click Accept.**
2. After Accept, the website gives that browser a random ID (a cookie) and records each page they view.
3. In the background, the IP address is looked up once (and not again for 30 days for the same address).
4. If it is an organisation, the company is saved and that visitor's lead is named after it and marked **Business IP**.
5. If the same visitor later fills in a quote, contact or pickup form, the enquiry shows their earlier visits, and the Visitor lead turns **Converted**.
6. The team sees it in the admin, and a summary email arrives every morning at 7 am Central.

What we use

Part	What it is	Cost
Our website and admin	Built into the existing site; data stays in our own database	Nothing new to host
ipapi.is	IP to organisation lookup	Free up to 1,000 lookups a day; $20 a month above that
DB-IP country file	Free location file already on our server, used to skip EU and UK visitors	Free
Our email server	Daily digest and Monday report	Already in use

Expected volume: 15,000 to 25,000 visits a month needs under 10,000 lookups a month, which fits the free plan.

Privacy safeguards

- **Consent first:** nothing happens unless the visitor accepts Analytics cookies. Declining, or a browser privacy signal (Global Privacy Control), means nothing is collected.
- **The raw IP address is never stored.** It is used once for the lookup, then only a scrambled one-way code is kept (deleted after 90 days).
- **Organisation level only:** we learn the company, never the person. A person is known only when they fill in a form themselves.
- **EU and UK visitors are never looked up.**
- A short paragraph is added to our **Privacy Policy**, and the system is switched on for the live site only after that wording is approved.
- Only approved admin users can see the data; nothing is shared outside the admin.

What to expect

- Roughly **1 in 4** business desktop visits will show a company name.
- Office networks show up; people at home, on mobile data or on a VPN stay anonymous. That is by design.
- Shared networks (coworking spaces, some large providers) can show the wrong company, so **Business IP is a sales signal, not proof** of who visited.

Where the team sees it

- **Admin, Visitors:** companies that visited, newest first, with pages read, number of visits, how they found us, and a Create lead button.
- **Admin, Visitor leads:** every consented visitor, with Business IP leads first.
- **Each enquiry:** a Visitor history panel showing what that person looked at before contacting us.
- **Daily email at 7 am Central** with new companies, and a weekly report on Mondays.

Status and next steps

Built and tested. To switch it on we need: (1) the free ipapi.is key, (2) our office and VPN IP addresses to exclude, (3) approval of the Privacy Policy wording. Then one week of testing on the dev site, a check against Google Analytics, and then the live site.